

Supplementary Material

Methods 1: Animal husbandry

Breeding colony - Juveniles of *L. delicata* came from a breeding colony established in the laboratory since 2019. This colony consisted of 270 adults housed in plastic containers (41.5 L x 30.5 W x 21 H cm) with six lizards (two males and four females) per enclosure. Enclosures were provided with shelter, nonstick matting, and several small water dishes. The lizards were fed approx. 40 mid-size crickets (*Acheta domestica*) per enclosure three days a week, and water was given daily. The crickets were dusted with calcium weekly and multivitamin and calcium biweekly. Room temperatures were set to 22-24 °C, but we also provided the enclosures with a heat chord and a heat lamp following a 12 h light:12 h dark cycle keeping warm side of enclosures is usually at 34 °C.

Eggs collection and incubation - Between mid-November 2023 to mid-January 2024, we placed a small box (12.5 L x 8.3 W x 5 H cm) with moist vermiculite in one side of the communal enclosures to provide females with a place to lay the eggs. These boxes were checked three days a week. After egg collection, we measured length and width with a digital caliper to the nearest 0.1 mm and weighted the eggs with a digital scale ± 0.001 g error. Then eggs were treated with CORT or vehicle (see CORT and temperature manipulation below) and were placed in individual cups (80 mL) with moist vermiculite (12 parts water to 4 parts vermiculite). The cups were covered with cling wrap to retain moisture and left in two incubators at two different temperatures (see CORT and temperature manipulation below) until hatching.

21 *Hatchlings* - Incubators were checked three times a week for hatchlings. Lizards were measured
22 and weighed immediately after hatching. snout-vent length (SVL) and tail length (TL) were
23 measured to the nearest millimeter, and weight was recorded using a digital scale with an
24 accuracy of ± 0.001 g. Hatchlings were then placed in individual enclosures (18.7L x 13.2W x
25 6.3H cm) with nonstick matting and a small water dish. Watering, feeding, and temperature
26 conditions were maintained as for adults (see above).

27

28 *Methods 2: flow cytometry*

29 *Brain mitochondrial activity*

30 **Homogenates:** After the medial cortex was extracted, it was transferred immediately to 1.5mL
31 centrifuge tubes containing 100 μ L of cold 1X PBS and kept on ice until further processing. The
32 tissue was mechanically homogenized by placing the tissue in the well of a 100 μ m mesh filter
33 (pluriStrainer) affixed atop a 1.5mL centrifuge tube, then mashed with the rubber end of an
34 insulin syringe stopper. The resulting homogenate was then rinsed through the filter with
35 1000 μ L of cold 1X PBS to prepare a homogenate suspension. Following homogenization, we
36 centrifuged each sample at 1000 RCF for 10 minutes to pellet cells, then removed the
37 supernatant (hereafter, this process referred to as ‘washing’) and resuspended the cells in 500 μ L
38 1x PBS. This step was performed to remove cellular debris from homogenates.

39 From each 500 μ L suspension of homogenate collected on a given trial day, we first added 100 μ L
40 of homogenate to a pooled sample of each tissue type to use for single-color controls, and the
41 remaining 400 μ L of homogenate was split among two 200 μ L aliquots. One aliquot was used
42 fresh to measure mitochondrial function (mitochondrial density, membrane potential, ROS), one
43 aliquot was cryopreserved for later measurements of oxidative damage (8-OHdG, lipid
44 peroxidation), and the third aliquot was cryopreserved for a different experiment.

45 **Staining fresh samples:** From fresh homogenate suspensions, we loaded the wells of a 96-well
46 flat-bottom plate (Nunc) with 50 μ L of homogenate in duplicates (2 wells per homogenate).
47 To each replicate well, we added 5 μ L of a fluorescent probe mix containing equal parts 5 μ M
48 MitoTracker Deep Red FM, 2.5 μ M MitoTracker Orange CMTMRos, and 50 μ M MitoSOX Red.
49 We used these fluorescent probes as indicators of mitochondrial density, mitochondrial

membrane potential, and superoxide (ROS) production, respectively. We then added 5 μ L of 10 μ g/mL Hoechst 33342 Nuclear Viability Dye to each sample, which we used to distinguish live, viable, intact cells from cellular debris. We then loaded 6 wells with 50 μ L of homogenate taken from each pooled homogenate suspension (12 wells total), which were to be negative and single-color controls. One well was left unstained as a negative control, one was stained with all the probes to be a positive control, and the remaining four wells were treated with 5 μ L of one of 5 μ M MitoTracker Deep Red FM, 2.5 μ M MitoTracker Orange CMTMRos, 50 μ M MitoSOX Red, or 10 μ g/mL Hoechst 33342 Nuclear Viability Dye. Any remaining pooled homogenate was fixed and frozen as previously described. We incubated the loaded plate at 32 °C for 30 minutes to stain and then diluted the samples with 50 μ L cold 1x PBS to halt the staining process. Upon the completion of staining, samples were immediately transferred to flow cytometry facilities for data collection and were sampled within 2 hours. Samples prepared this way remained viable for flow cytometry for approximately 5 hours post-staining at room temperature (~19°C) before cells began rapidly degrading (DCL, personal observation).

The aliquots destined to the analysis of oxidative damage were stained with 20 μ L (10 μ L for controls) of 10 μ g/mL Hoechst 33342 Nuclear Viability Dye and 20 μ L of 100 μ M BODIPY 665/676 Lipid Peroxidation Sensor and incubated at 32°C for 20 minutes. Following staining, we washed cells to prevent further binding of unbound fluorescent probes, then resuspended the pellet and continue with cryopreservation.

Cryopreservation: Aliquots were fixed first by adding the samples into a 1mL solution of 1% Neutral-Buffered Formalin (as a fixative agent) and incubating them at 32°C for 20 min. Then washed the samples and resuspended the cells in 1mL cold 1X Tris-EDTA (chelates metals that

can damage DNA during freezing) and 10% DMSO (a cryoprotectant). Samples were stored at -20°C until oxidative damage assays.

Staining cryopreserved samples: Assays of oxidative damage from cryopreserved samples were performed within 6 months of the initial processing and analysis of fresh samples. On the day of oxidative damage assays, we rapidly thawed frozen samples by briefly (1-2 minutes) submerging them in hot water. We washed each thawed sample twice, the first time resuspending the pelleted cells in 1000µL warm 1X Tris-EDTA, and the second time in 200µL warm 1X PBS containing 20µM digitonin. We incubated the samples at 32°C for 20 minutes to permeabilize the cell membrane, after which we washed the homogenate and resuspended the pelleted cells in 200µL 1X PBS. We added 20µL of 70µM 8-OHdG Polyclonal Antibody to each sample, and we left the homogenate overnight (~12 hours) for the antibody to bind to 8-OHdG, a marker of oxidative damage on DNA. The following day we counterstained the cells with 20µL of 100 µg/mL H+G Goat Anti-Rabbit Conjugate Antibody with Alexa-Fluor 488 at 32°C for 20 minutes. After the cells had been tagged with 8-OHdG antibodies and counterstained, we washed the cells once more and resuspended the pellet in 400µL of 1X PBS. Unstained and single-color controls were treated identically to samples, but stained with only up to one of BODIPY 665/676, Hoechst 33342, 8-OHdG antibody, or Alexa-Fluor 488 conjugate. Additionally, one control was stained with both 8-OHdG antibody and the Alexa-Fluor 488 conjugate. We then loaded a 96-well plate with 100µL of each single-color control and 100µL in triplicate of each sample. We performed all flow cytometry assays on samples within 48-hours of thawing the samples.

Flow cytometry: All flow cytometry assays were performed using a flow cytometer with 5-lasers (blue, red, yellow-green, violet, and ultraviolet), 20 detectors, and a high-throughput plate

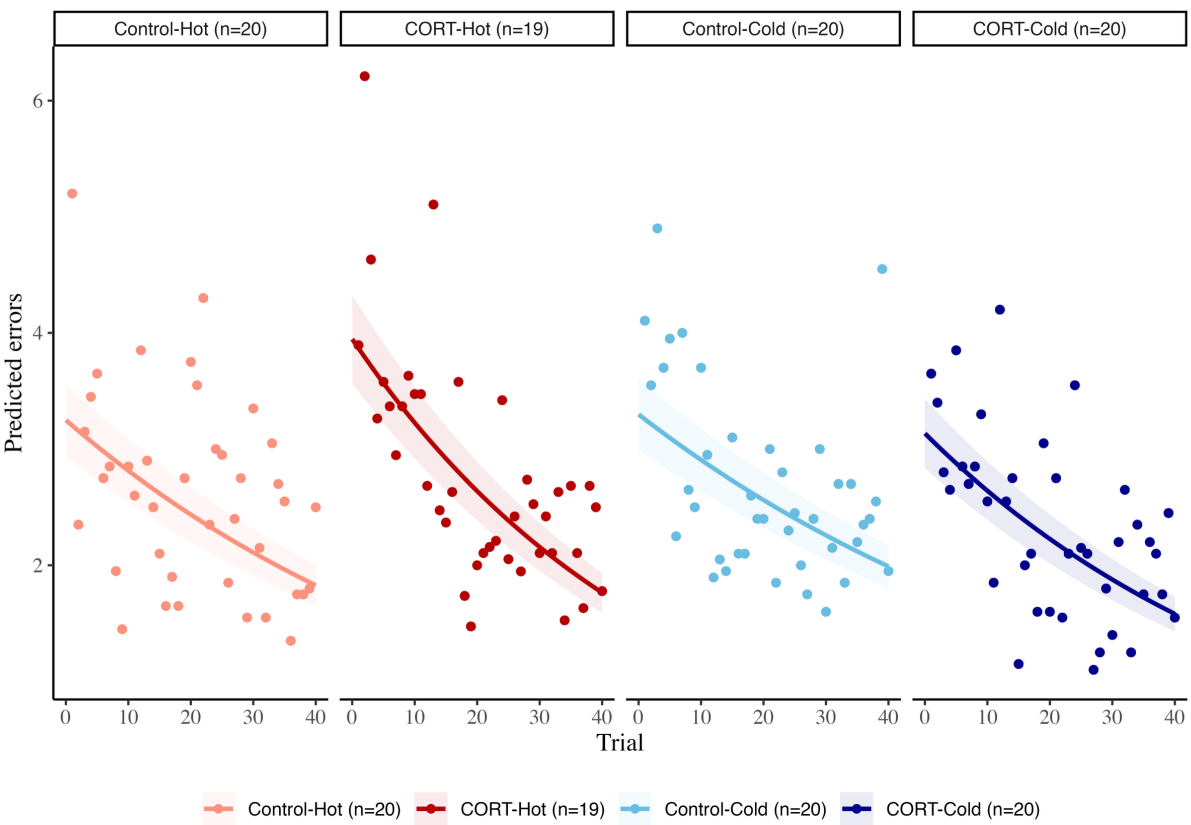
95 reader (Becton Dickson LSRFortessa X-20) using the default wavelength filters on detectors.
96 Immediately prior to all assays, we performed a quality-control check and laser alignment using
97 the CS&T function of BD FACSDiva (v. 8.0.1) and BD CS&T fluorescent beads (Lot
98 No. 30664) diluted at 1 drop to 150 μ L 1X PBS. During data collection, data for single-color
99 controls was filtered using a liberal threshold of 200 on the FSC (roughly, cell size) detector,
100 while data from samples was filtered using a threshold of 200 on the BUV-496 (Hoechst 33342)
101 detector. These thresholds were chosen to filter small debris or inviable or non-intact cells from
102 our observations. The detectors and voltage settings used in data acquisition for each assay type
103 (mitochondrial function, oxidative damage) were determined during pilot trials prior to assays
104 and were not changed during assays to allow for comparison among different plates and samples
105 throughout the experiment. Voltages were chosen to center the distribution of observations in
106 each channel at 10^3 fluorescent intensity and reduce observations of off-scale ($<10^1$ or $>10^5$)
107 events. For the mitochondrial function assay, we recorded data from the following channels (in
108 brackets: voltage; parameter): FSC (44; forward scatter), SSC (180; side scatter), Alexa-Fluor
109 488 (544; autofluorescence), BUV-496 (450; Hoechst 33342), APC (647; MitoTracker Deep Red
110 FM), PE (522; MitoTracker Orange CMTMRos), and PerCP-Cy5-5 (592; MitoSOX Red)
111 channels. For the oxidative damage assay, we recorded data from the following channels: FSC
112 (425; forward scatter), SSC (300; side scatter), Alexa-Fluor 488 (275; 8-OHdG Antibody +
113 Alexa-Fluor 488 conjugate), BUV-496 (525; Hoechst 33342), and PE-Cy5 (850; BODIPY
114 665/676). Fluorescent intensity data was collected via the BD FACSDiva (v. 8.0.1) software,
115 with no compensation applied during data collection, and all on a linear scale (detectable range
116 of 0-252166). We recorded data for both the area and height of the fluorescent signal, but only
117 used the area in downstream analyses, with height being recorded for the sake of quality control.

Data was exported from BD FACSDiva as individual *.fcs (“flow cytometry standard”) files for each sample, then imported into FlowJo (v. 10.1) for processing.

Data processing: In FlowJo v. 10.1 we first transformed all fluorescent data to a logarithmic base 10 scale, then applied a basic gating process across all channels by filtering to observations within the detectable range (10^1 - 10^5) to remove any off-scale events. We then used a backgating process wherein we aimed to identify the approximate FSC (cell size) and SSC (cell complexity) range of viable cells that were positive for all stains. We primarily used the BUV-496 channel (Hoechst 33342) in the backgating process to identify intact, nucleated cells ($\text{BUV-496} > 10^3$). For the mitochondrial function assay, we aimed to identify populations of viable cells containing mitochondria ($\text{APC} > 10^3$) and actively respiring (PE and $\text{PerCP-Cy5-5} > 10^3$). For the oxidative damage assay, we aimed to identify populations of cells exhibiting both DNA damage ($\text{Alexa-Fluor 488} > 10^3$) and lipid peroxidation ($\text{PerCP} > 10^3$). When backgating was done, we filtered the data to the FSC by SSC range that captured the ideal population. We used the backgated population for compensation of fluorescent spillover between different fluorescent probes. To account for fluorescent spillover, we used a traditional compensation matrix using the compensation function of FlowJo v.10.1. We identified the “positive” population for each channel as the brightest ~2.5% of the distribution of observations in the respective single-color control for that channel and used unstained controls as a universal negative. We visually inspected the compensation matrix and its effects on population distributions for under- and over-compensation, whereupon we changed the compensation matrix manually until data was properly compensated. We applied the compensation matrix to all samples for downstream processing. Following compensation, we again gated the data following the same process as for backgating but using the compensated parameters for each channel. Following gating, we

141 exported the geometric mean (mean fluorescent intensity; MFI) and robust confidence-values for
142 each channel for each sample. For analysis, we exported summary statistics of only the area of
143 the fluorescent signal. Although we exported robust confidence values for checking repeatability
144 between replicate samples, we used the geometric means for each individual as our main
145 response variables in analyses.

146



148
149 Figure S1. Raw data of the learning task. Each point represents the mean number of errors per
150 day. The lines represent the modeled data.

152 *Table S1. Estimates of the learning slopes per treatment, the 95% CI, and pMCMC values testing*
 153 *the hypothesis that slope is different from 0. In bold, the values that are significant at pMCMC <*
 154 *0.05.*

Treatment	Estimated slope	95 CI	pMCMC
CORT-Cold	-0.017	[-0.026, -0.008]	< 0.001
CORT-Hot	-0.020	[-0.029, -0.011]	< 0.001
Control-Cold	-0.013	[-0.021, -0.004]	< 0.05
Control-Hot	-0.014	[-0.023, -0.006]	< 0.05

155

156 Table S2. Estimate of the contrasts between treatments for all the variables analysed, and
 157 *p*MCMC values testing the hypothesis that contrast is different from 0. In bold, the values that
 158 are significant at *p*MCMC < 0.05.

Variable	Predictor	Contrast	pMCMC contrast
Mit density	Temperature	-0.018	0.917
	CORT	0.134	0.471
	Interaction	0.176	0.437
Metabolic capacity	Temperature	-0.036	0.839
	CORT	0.162	0.364
	Interaction	0.135	0.559
ROS	Temperature	-0.032	0.875
	CORT	0.148	0.450
	Interaction	0.199	0.382
DNA damage	Temperature	0.007	0.970
	CORT	0.217	0.394
	Interaction	-0.128	0.706
Lipid peroxidation	Temperature	-0.601	0.106
	CORT	0.093	0.701
	Interaction	-0.037	0.909
Learning slopes	Temperature	-0.002	0.701
	CORT	0.005	0.416
	Interaction	0.001	0.881

159 Contrasts were done by:

160 - *Temperature*: $\beta_{\text{Hot}} - \beta_{\text{Cold}}$

161 - *CORT*: $\beta_{\text{CORT}} - \beta_{\text{Control}}$

162 - *Interaction*: $(\beta_{\text{Control-Hot}} - \beta_{\text{CORT-Hot}}) - (\beta_{\text{Control-Cold}} - \beta_{\text{CORT-Cold}})$

163

164 *Clutch effects of the final univariate models*

165 *Table S3. Clutch effect of the final univariate models*

Variable	Mean_effect	95% CI
Mit density	0.192	[0.014, 0.398]
Mit potential	0.112	[0.004, 0.293]
ROS	0.123	[0.006, 0.310]
DNA damage	0.191	[0.009, 0.456]
Peroxidation	0.149	[0.006, 0.386]
Learning	0.073	[0.003, 0.183]

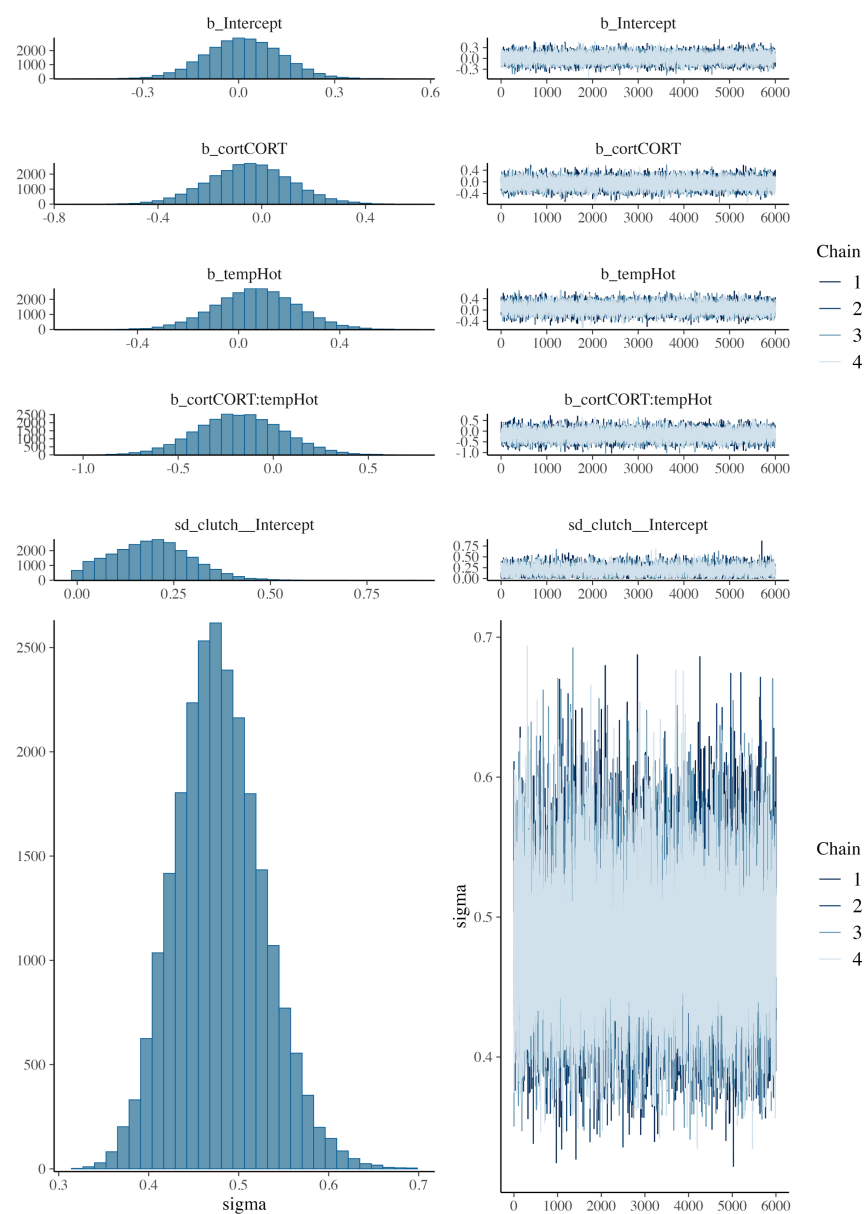
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169 *Table S4. Estimated direct, indirect, and total coefficients from the multivariate model*

Response	Predictor	Direct effects	Indirect effects	Total effects
Learning	Mitochondrial density	0.068 [-0.270, 0.402]	0.003 [-0.036, 0.049]	0.071 [-0.269, 0.408]
	Metabolic capacity	0.025 [-0.311, 0.358]	-0.012 [-0.124, 0.088]	0.013 [-0.329, 0.357]
	ROS	-	-0.011 [-0.109, 0.080]	-0.011 [-0.109, 0.080]
	DNA damage	0.031 [-0.185, 0.241]	-	0.031 [-0.185, 0.241]
	Lipid peroxidation	-0.119 [-0.324, 0.102]	-	-0.119 [-0.324, 0.102]
DNA damage	Mitochondrial density	-	-0.037 [-0.279, 0.145]	-0.037 [-0.279, 0.145]
	Metabolic capacity	-	0.137 [-0.322, 0.654]	0.137 [-0.322, 0.654]
	ROS	0.125 [-0.292, 0.540]	-	0.125 [-0.292, 0.540]
Lipid peroxidation	Mitochondrial density	-	-0.023 [-0.243, 0.159]	-0.023 [-0.243, 0.159]
	Metabolic capacity	-	0.085 [-0.374, 0.583]	0.085 [-0.374, 0.583]
	ROS	0.076 [-0.335, 0.485]	-	0.076 [-0.335, 0.485]
ROS	Mitochondrial density	-0.282 [-0.932, 0.359]	-	-0.282 [-0.932, 0.359]
	Metabolic capacity	1.090 [0.447, 1.738]	-	1.090 [0.447, 1.738]

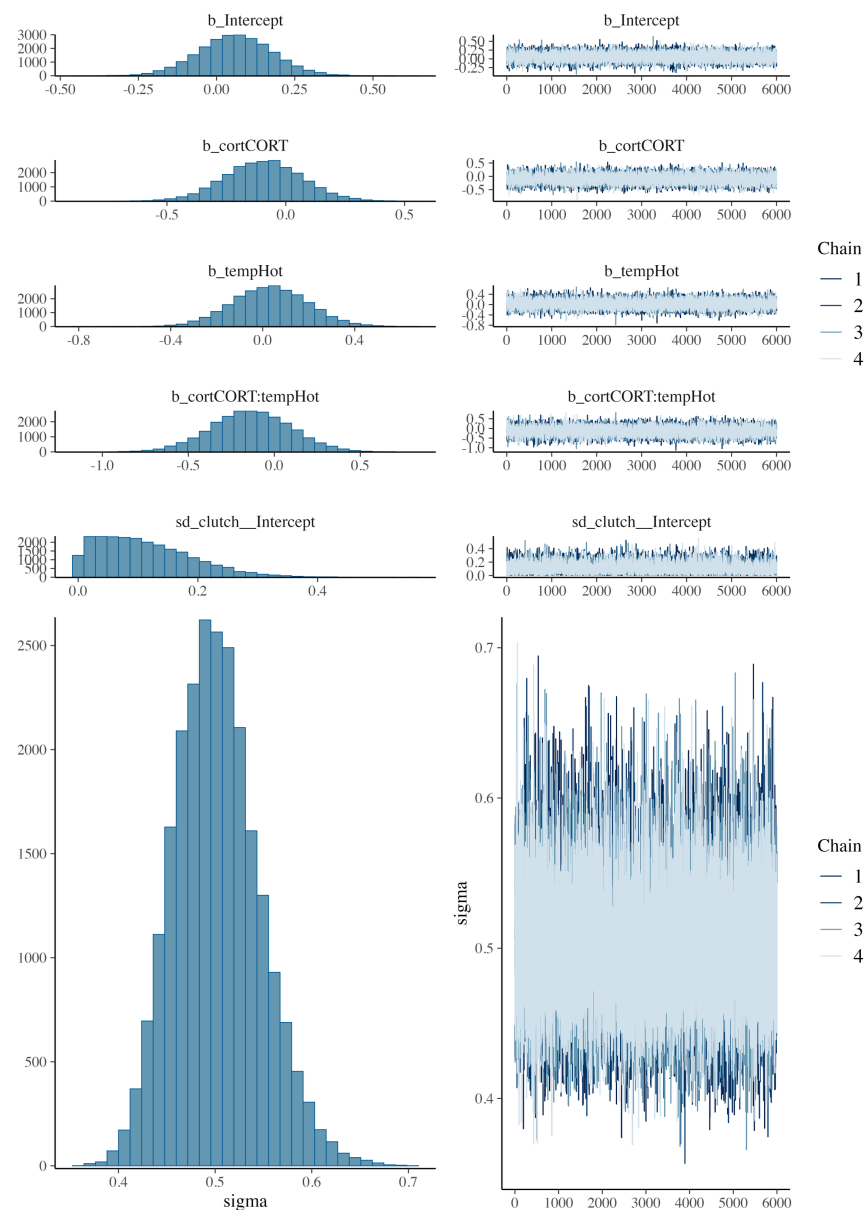
171 *Final univariate models diagnostics (plots)*



172 Figure S2. Posterior predictive checks for the model of Mitochondrial Density. Formula:

173 $\text{mit_density} \sim \text{cort} * \text{temp} + (1|\text{clutch})$

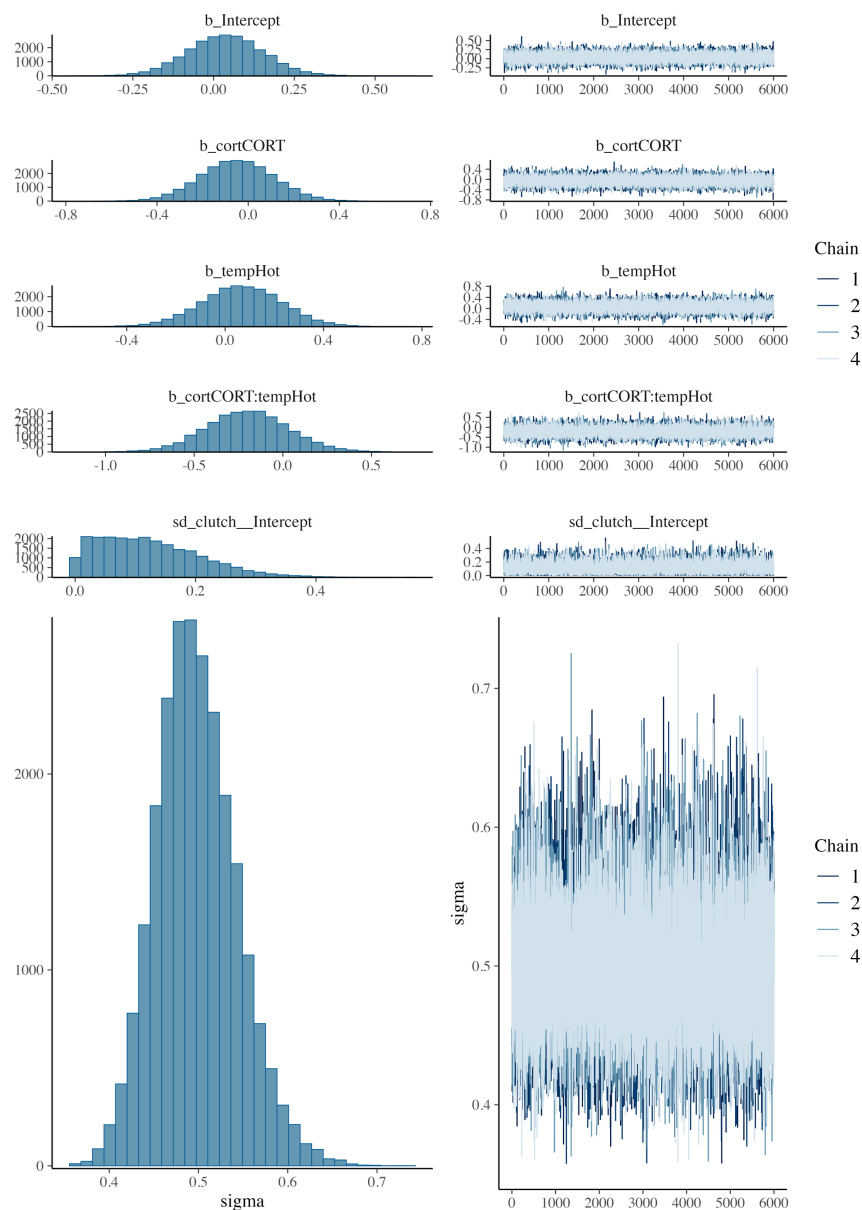
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175 Figure S3. Posterior predictive checks for the model of metabolic capacity. Formula:

176 $mit_potential \sim cort * temp + (1|clutch)$

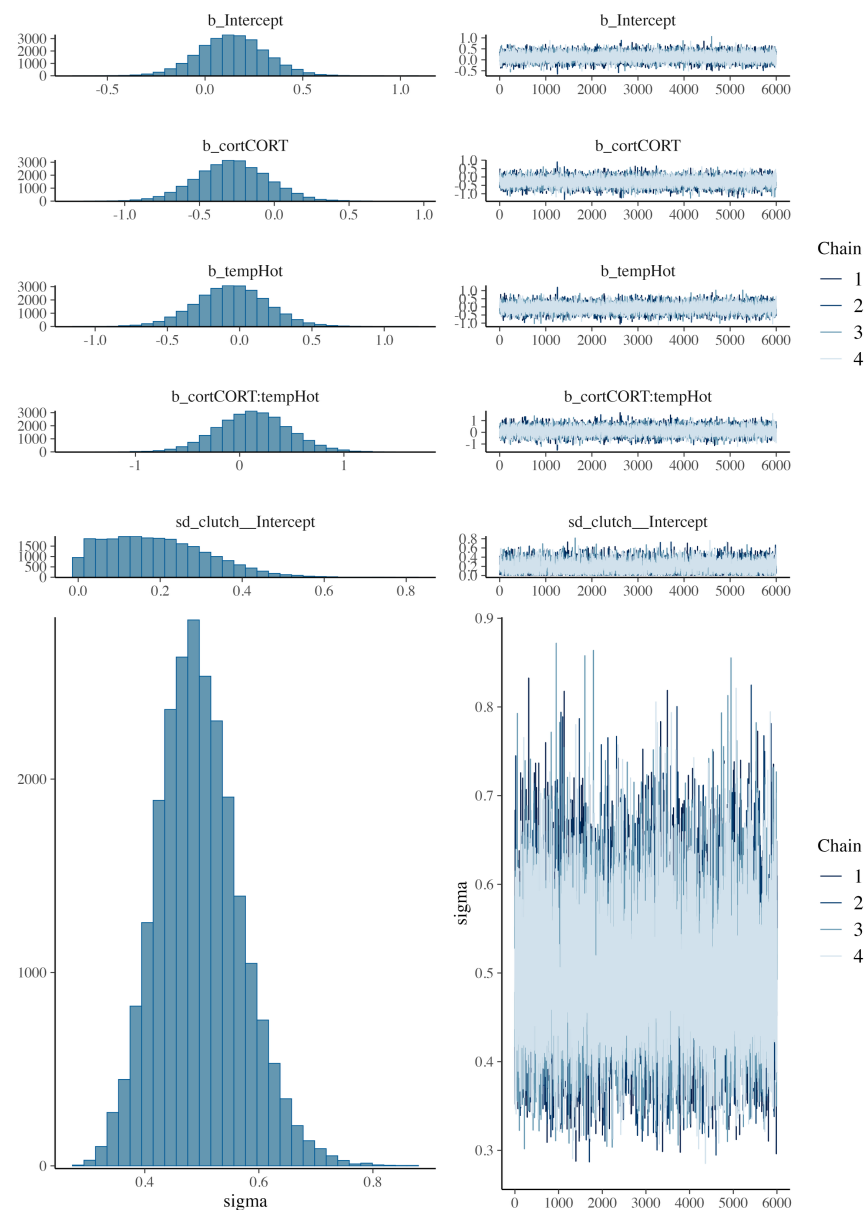
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178 Figure S4. Posterior predictive checks for the model of ROS. Formula: $ROS \sim cort * temp +$

179 $(1|clutch)$

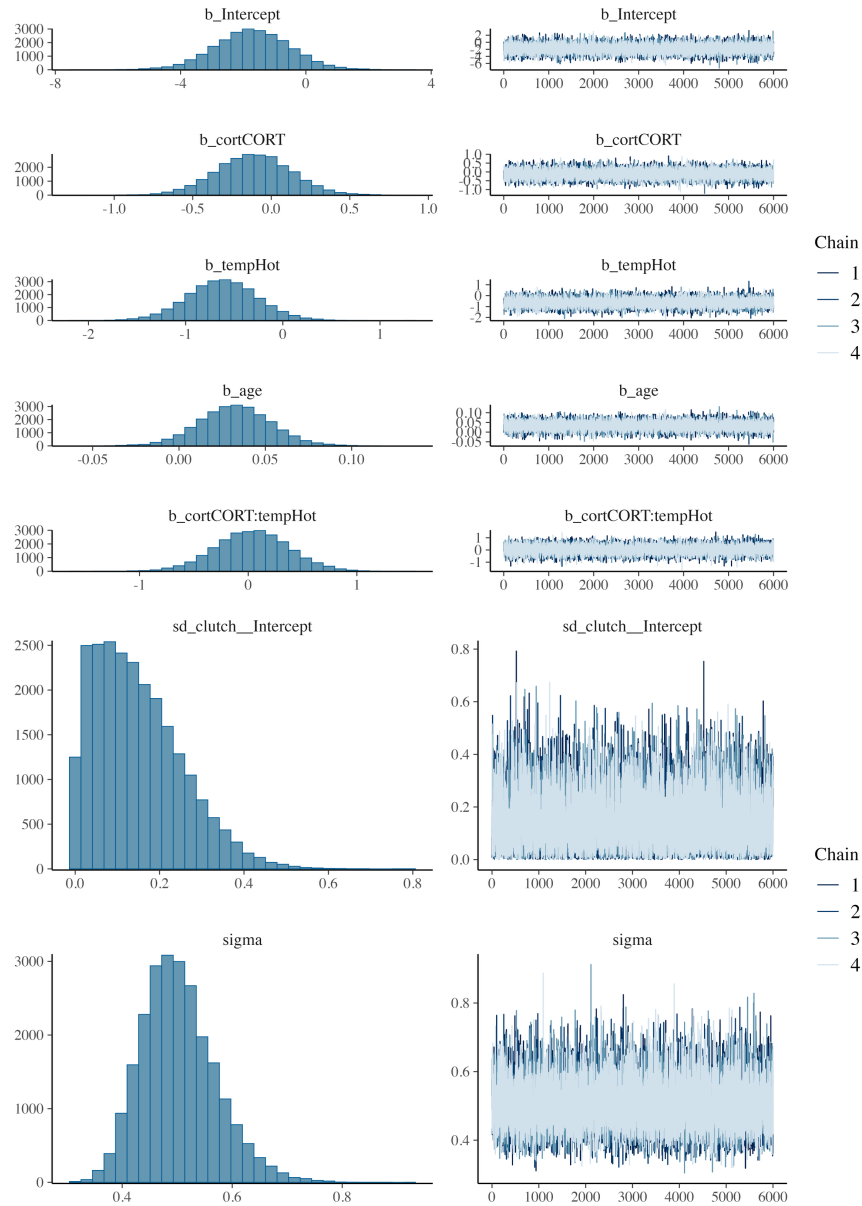
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181 Figure S5. Posterior predictive checks for the model of DNA Damage. Formula: $DNAdamage \sim$

182 $cort * temp + (1|clutch)$

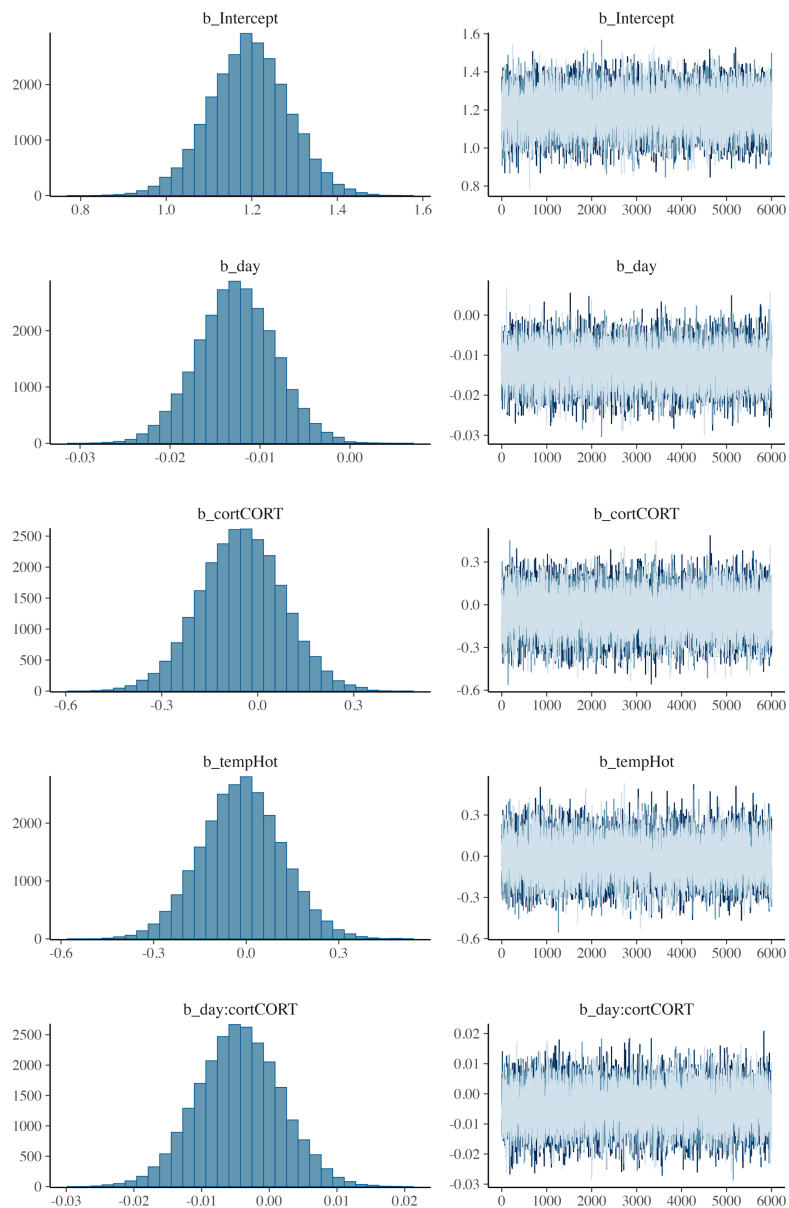
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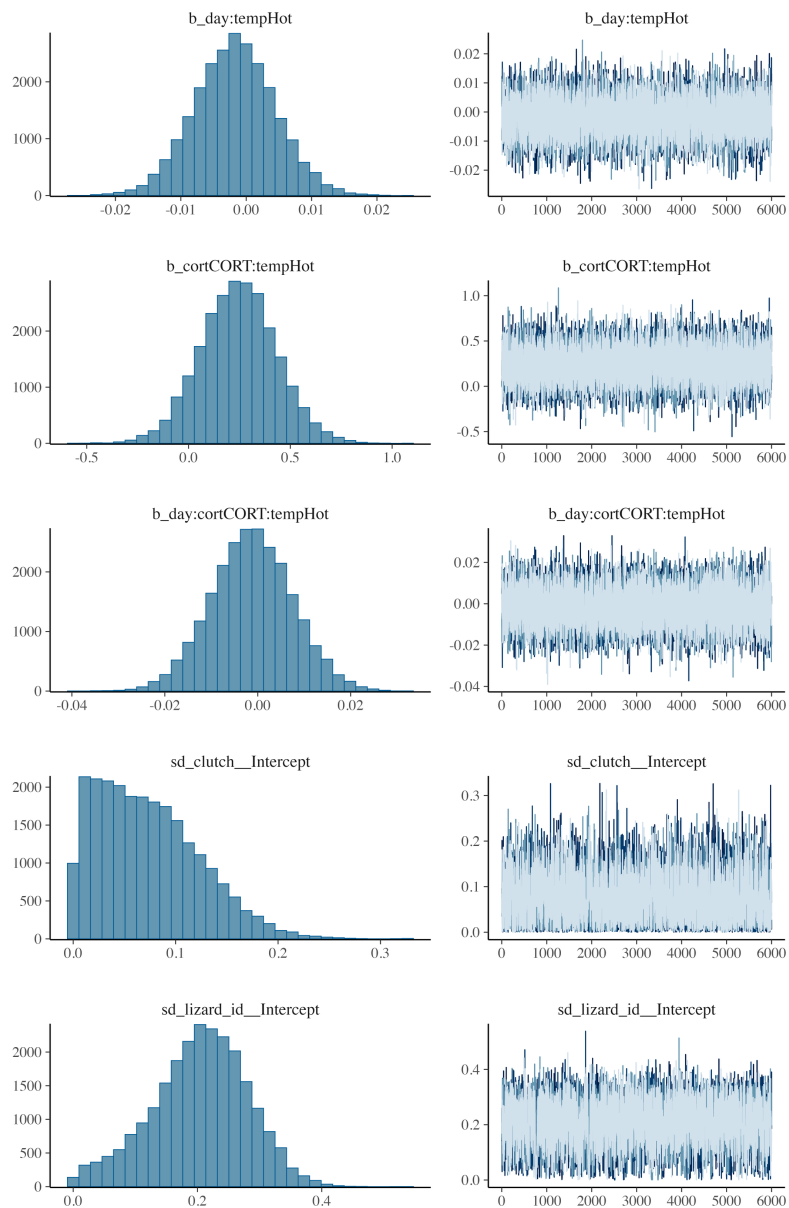


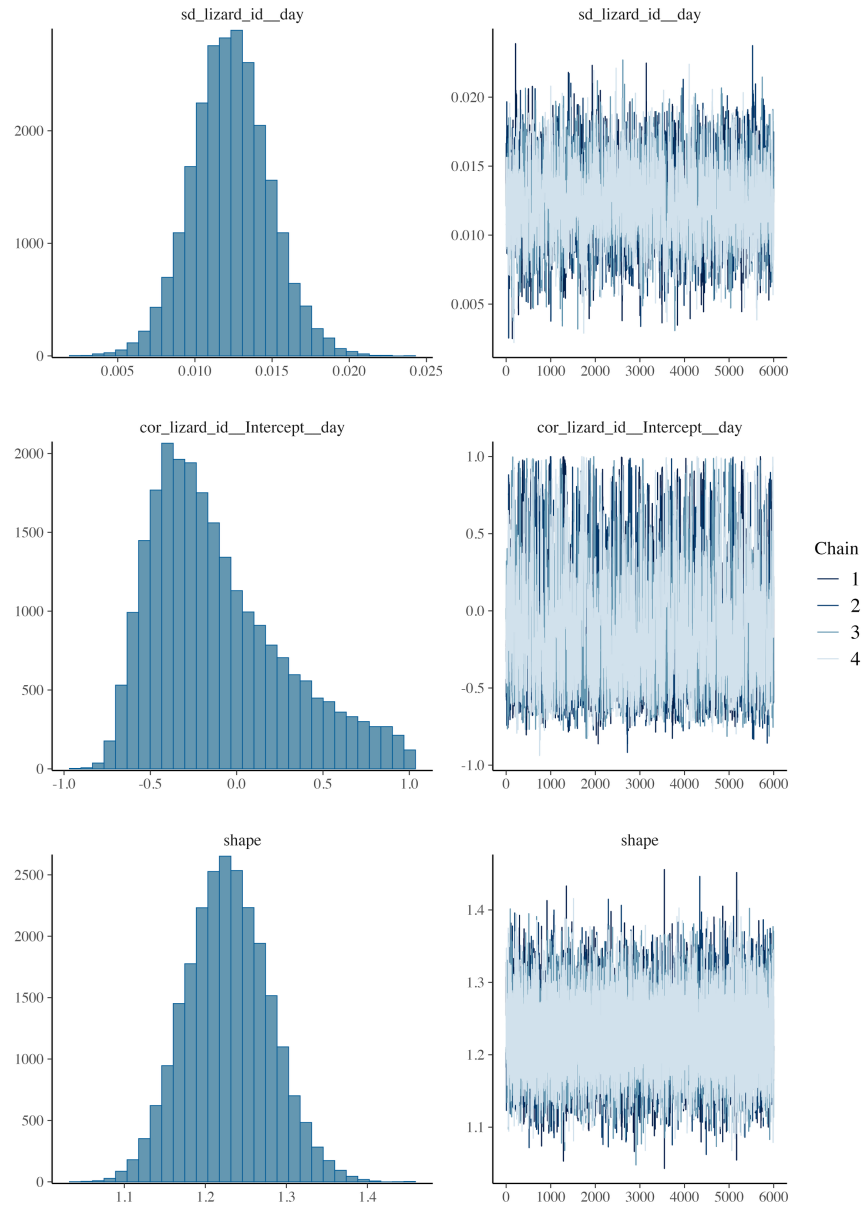
184 Figure S6. Posterior predictive checks for the model of lipid peroxidation. Formula: peroxidation

185 $\sim \text{cort} * \text{temp} + (1|\text{clutch})$

186







187 Figure S7. Posterior predictive checks for the model of spatial learning. Formula: $\text{errors} \sim \text{day} *$

188 $\text{cort} * \text{temp} + (1 + \text{day} | \text{lizard_id}) + (1 | \text{clutch})$

189

191 *Table S5. Preliminary results of the models testing for Mitochondrial Density.*

variable	mean	median	sd	mad	q5	q95	rhat	ess_bulk	ess_tail
b_Intercept	0.470	0.460	0.866	0.855	-0.947	1.907	1	19,362.26	16,116.88
b_cortCO RT	-0.054	-0.055	0.161	0.160	-0.316	0.211	1	23,841.57	18,938.53
b_tempHot	0.177	0.175	0.255	0.254	-0.240	0.598	1	18,264.83	15,601.67
b_age	-0.008	-0.008	0.015	0.015	-0.033	0.016	1	18,809.92	15,827.44
b_sex	-0.012	-0.012	0.122	0.122	-0.212	0.187	1	32,791.21	19,114.69
b_cortCO RT:tempHot	-0.163	-0.161	0.234	0.231	-0.547	0.219	1	23,053.19	18,337.06

192 Model formula: mit_density ~ cort * temp + age + sex + (1|clutch). Model convergence was
193 checked through rhat and ess_bulk values. Summary indicates no effect of sex or age, so they
194 were discarded from the final models.

196 *Table S6. Preliminary results of the models testing for Metabolic capacity.*

variable	mean	median	sd	mad	q5	q95	rhat	ess_bulk	ess_tail
b_Intercept	0.302	0.296	0.847	0.839	-1.088	1.697	1	18,682.53	16,852.64
b_cortCO RT	-0.095	-0.094	0.166	0.165	-0.369	0.178	1	22,493.38	18,602.43
b_tempHot	0.092	0.091	0.248	0.247	-0.315	0.501	1	18,415.30	16,061.12
b_age	-0.004	-0.004	0.014	0.014	-0.028	0.019	1	18,669.13	16,525.89
b_sex	0.017	0.016	0.126	0.125	-0.191	0.225	1	31,266.98	17,493.28
b_cortCO RT:tempHot	-0.137	-0.137	0.242	0.240	-0.534	0.258	1	21,436.04	16,972.70

197 Model formula: mit_potential ~ cort * temp + age + sex + (1|clutch). Model convergence was
198 checked through rhat and ess_bulk values. Summary indicates no effect of sex or age, so they
199 were discarded from the final models.

200

201 *Table S7. Preliminary results of the models testing for ROS.*

variable	mean	median	sd	mad	q5	q95	rhat	ess_bulk	ess_tail
b_Intercept	0.441	0.439	0.845	0.846	-0.938	1.829	1	19,954.88	17,733.51
b_cortCORT	-0.059	-0.058	0.163	0.162	-0.329	0.206	1	21,973.58	19,467.53
b_tempHot	0.160	0.157	0.245	0.245	-0.241	0.565	1	18,615.90	16,581.43
b_age	-0.007	-0.007	0.014	0.014	-0.031	0.016	1	19,777.02	17,300.71
b_sex	0.021	0.021	0.124	0.123	-0.183	0.224	1	33,495.85	18,274.71
b_cortCORT:tempHot	-0.183	-0.184	0.236	0.235	-0.572	0.203	1	21,404.60	18,058.25

202 Model formula: $ROS \sim cort * temp + age + sex + (1|clutch)$. Model convergence was checked
203 through rhat and ess_bulk values. Summary indicates no effect of sex or age, so they were
204 discarded from the final models.

205

206 *Table S8. Preliminary results of the models testing for DNA damage.*

variable	mean	median	sd	mad	q5	q95	rhat	ess_bulk	ess_tail
b_Intercept	-0.814	-0.815	1.333	1.286	-2.975	1.384	1	14,193.24	15,015.86
b_cortCORT	-0.286	-0.287	0.249	0.244	-0.695	0.125	1	16,764.42	17,646.72
b_tempHot	-0.278	-0.280	0.402	0.393	-0.936	0.384	1	12,803.98	14,601.59
b_age	0.017	0.017	0.023	0.022	-0.021	0.054	1	13,624.26	14,032.51
b_sex	0.030	0.031	0.185	0.181	-0.274	0.330	1	20,984.11	17,159.64
b_cortCORT:tempHot	0.108	0.107	0.355	0.350	-0.475	0.690	1	14,479.58	15,703.47

207 Model formula: DNAdamage ~ cort * temp + age + sex + (1|clutch). Model convergence was
208 checked through rhat and ess_bulk values. Summary indicates no effect of sex or age, so they
209 were discarded from the final models.

210

211 *Table S9. Preliminary results of the models testing for lipid peroxidation.*

variable	mean	median	sd	mad	q5	q95	rhat	ess_bulk	ess_tail
b_Intercept	-1.960	-1.944	1.280	1.237	-4.098	0.117	1	17,308.48	15,369.02
b_cortCORT	-0.139	-0.139	0.242	0.237	-0.537	0.256	1	17,466.19	16,492.63
b_tempHot	-0.691	-0.691	0.386	0.374	-1.328	-0.056	1	14,335.87	14,037.45
b_age	0.036	0.036	0.022	0.021	0.000	0.073	1	16,551.88	15,440.72
b_sex	0.119	0.119	0.179	0.175	-0.171	0.414	1	23,967.02	17,240.50
b_cortCORT:tempHot	0.051	0.049	0.337	0.330	-0.508	0.603	1	18,089.57	17,414.62

212 Model formula: peroxidation ~ cort * temp + age + sex + (1|clutch). Model convergence was
 213 checked through rhat and ess_bulk values. Summary indicates no effect of sex, so it was
 214 discarded from the final models. However, we saw an effect of age and we included it in our
 215 final models.

216

217 *Table S10. Preliminary results of the models testing for learning.*

variable	mean	median	sd	mad	q5	q95	rhat	ess_bulk	ess_tail
b_Intercept	1.350	1.348	0.546	0.537	0.455	2.256	1	14,157.44 ₃	16,878.70
b_day	-0.013	-0.013	0.004	0.004	-0.020	-0.005	1	9,398.846	13,567.40
b_cortCORT	-0.054	-0.052	0.134	0.136	-0.275	0.164	1	10,693.40 ₉	14,518.00
b_tempHot	0.023	0.022	0.180	0.178	-0.269	0.322	1	10,924.74 ₂	15,119.67
b_sex	-0.005	-0.005	0.080	0.079	-0.136	0.128	1	16,727.89 ₁	17,160.45
b_age	-0.003	-0.003	0.009	0.009	-0.018	0.012	1	13,505.07 ₃	16,391.78
b_day:cortCORT	-0.004	-0.005	0.006	0.006	-0.015	0.006	1	9,216.274	12,908.06
b_day:tempHot	-0.002	-0.002	0.006	0.006	-0.012	0.008	1	9,945.670	13,744.26
b_cortCORT:tempHot	0.242	0.241	0.194	0.194	-0.076	0.563	1	10,111.70 ₀	14,279.42
b_day:cortCORT:tempHot	0.000	0.000	0.009	0.009	-0.015	0.014	1	9,169.257	12,700.42

218 Model formula: errors ~ day * cort * temp + sex + age + (1 + day | lizard_id) + (1|clutch). Model

219 convergence was checked through rhat and ess_bulk values. Summary indicates no effect of sex

220 or age, so they were discarded from the final models.

221

222 *Brain validation*

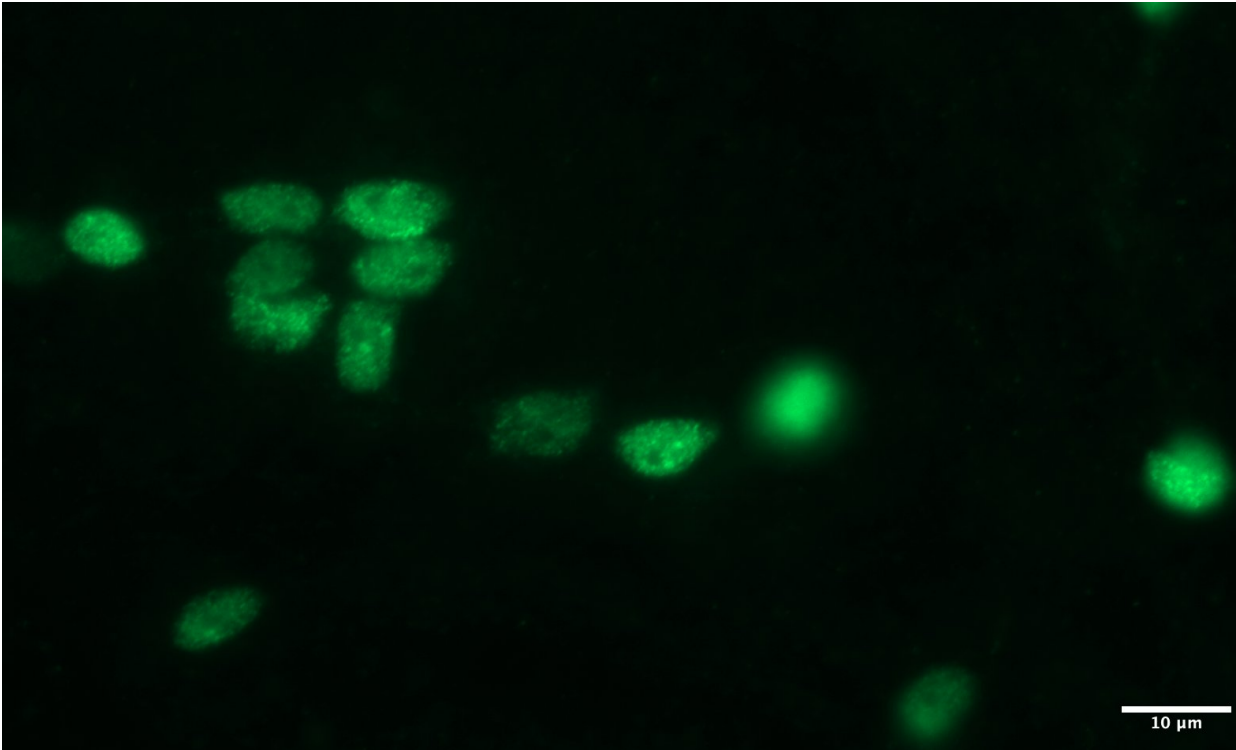
223 To ensure that neurons were not unintentionally lost during homogenization, we performed a
224 pilot study where we euthanized four lizards and prepared medial cortex homogenates using the
225 same procedures as before. However, to ensure we could identify neurons, homogenates here
226 were dyed with marker that specifically targeted neuron nuclei (Farrow et al., 2021; Storks et al.,
227 2023). We employed fluorescence microscopy and flow cytometry to check for the presence of
228 neurons in the homogenates.

229 Euthanasia and homogenization for each of brain region followed the procedures outlined above
230 (see *Methods 2: Flow cytometry*). Before staining the samples, cells were also fixed and
231 permeabilized as described previously (see *Methods 2: Flow cytometry*). Following
232 permeabilization, we centrifuged the samples at 1000 RCF for 10 minutes and resuspended the
233 pellet in 100 μ L of a 1:100 dilution of NeuN + Alexa488 fluorescent conjugate to dye the
234 neuronal nuclei (Farrow et al., 2021; Storks et al., 2023). The samples were incubated at +4 °C
235 overnight.

236 The following day we centrifuged the samples at 1000 RCF for 10 minutes and resuspended the
237 pellet in 100 μ L of PBS. Samples were split in two: 50 μ L from each was reserved for
238 examination under a Zeiss AxioObserver Z1 microscope, while the remaining 50 μ L from each
239 sample was pooled into a single tube for flow cytometry analysis. . Flow cytometry of stained
240 cells allowed us to validate that our gating strategy was correct.

241 Samples examined under the microscope showed a clear presence of neuronal nuclei in the
242 homogenates (Figure S13). Flow cytometry analysis also confirmed the presence of neuronal

243 nuclei in the homogenates, that were similar to the size of the cells employed in the experiment
244 (mean size cells experiment = 2.765; 95% CI = [2.093, 3.139], n = 80; size neurons = 3.977495).



245 Figure S8. Fluorescence microscopy image of neuron nuclei stained with NeuN-Alexa 488.
246 Images were taken on a Zeiss AxioObserver Z1, equipped with Zeiss AxioCam 506 monochrome
247 camera. A Zeiss 38HE fluorescent filter set (450-490nm Ex, 500-550nm Em.) was used in
248 conjunction with a 63x 1.4 NA.

249

250 REFERENCES

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